PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Security Engineering Consultant | SIEM/XDR Detection Engineering | SOAR | KQL | MITRE ATT&CK

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Senior Security Engineering Consultant with over five years of hands-on experience in Security Operations Centre (SOC) engineering, Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) and Extended Detection and Response (XDR) deployment, detection rule development, and Security Orchestration Automation and Response (SOAR) automation. In my current role at the University of the Arts London (UAL), I design and implement detection rule sets across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), writing custom Kusto Query Language (KQL) logic mapped to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and building SOAR playbooks to automate threat triage and response workflows. I hold the Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) certification and bring strong expertise in vulnerability management using Tenable.io, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), and AppCheck, as well as Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Azure cloud security, and PowerShell and Python scripting. I am comfortable engaging with customers and internal stakeholders as a trusted technical consultant and thrive in Professional Services environments where I can translate detection engineering expertise into tangible security improvements for clients.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM/XDR Detection Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (SIEM), CrowdStrike Falcon (NG-SIEM, EDR, Prevent, Insight, Discover), KQL detection rule authoring, MITRE ATT&CK mapping
- **SOAR and Automation:** Microsoft Sentinel playbooks, Logic Apps, SOAR workflow design, PowerShell scripting, Python scripting
- **Microsoft Security Stack:** Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD), Microsoft Entra ID
- **Vulnerability and Exposure Management:** Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus, Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Continuous Threat Exposure Management (CTEM)
- **Identity and Access Management:** Azure AD, Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Network and Endpoint Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Microsoft Intune Mobile Device Management (MDM), Tanium, Mimecast
- **Cloud Security:** Microsoft Azure, Azure Security Centre, Azure Monitor, cloud security health checks and hardening
- **Frameworks:** MITRE ATT&CK, NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), NIST 800-61, CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials Plus

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer

- Design and implement SIEM and XDR detection rule sets across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM, writing custom KQL detection logic and tuning correlation rules to reduce false positives while maintaining high-fidelity alert coverage against MITRE ATT&CK techniques.
- Build and maintain SOAR playbooks using Microsoft Sentinel Logic Apps, automating alert enrichment, user account isolation, threat intelligence lookups, and ticketing integration, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and manual analyst workload significantly.
- Deploy, configure and tune CrowdStrike Falcon EDR, Falcon Insight (threat hunting), and Falcon Discover (asset management) across an 8,000-user estate, providing full endpoint visibility and enabling proactive threat hunting.
- Configure and manage Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE) and Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI) policies, including attack surface reduction (ASR) rules, tamper protection, and identity-based detection tuning.
- Conduct vulnerability and exposure management using Tenable.io, AppCheck and Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), validating detection coverage and identifying gaps in existing SIEM and XDR detection logic.

- Perform Azure cloud security health checks, reviewing Azure Security Centre recommendations, identity configurations, and storage and network security controls to reduce cloud attack surface.
- Engage with internal stakeholders as a trusted security engineering advisor, presenting detection coverage reports, risk assessments, and remediation roadmaps to senior leadership.
- Author PowerShell and Python scripts to automate security operations tasks, including log parsing, alert data enrichment, compliance checks, and vulnerability report generation.

University of the Arts London (UAL) *March 2022 - March 2025*

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity

- Developed and tuned SIEM detection rules in Microsoft Sentinel using KQL, implementing correlation logic for lateral movement, credential abuse, and data exfiltration detection scenarios aligned to MITRE ATT&CK.
- Built SOAR automation workflows to streamline alert triage, reducing analyst investigation time by automating first-level enrichment steps including user context lookups, IP reputation checks, and asset classification.
- Administered BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), enforcing least-privilege access and just-in-time (JIT) elevation for administrative accounts, with full session recording and monitoring.
- Supported deployment and configuration of Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), tuning detection policies and configuring custom indicators of compromise (IoCs) for threat intelligence integration.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments with Nessus and AppCheck, mapping findings to NIST CSF controls and producing prioritised remediation plans.
- Performed threat hunting using CrowdStrike Falcon Insight, developing hunting hypotheses based on threat intelligence and MITRE ATT&CK adversary techniques to identify undetected threats.

HICX Solutions Ltd (SaaS / FinTech) *February 2021 - March 2022*

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure

- Delivered security engineering and infrastructure support across a SaaS and FinTech environment, implementing endpoint security controls and cloud infrastructure hardening measures.
- Conducted vulnerability assessments using Nessus, documenting findings and supporting remediation activities.
- Managed identity and access management for cloud and on-premises systems, administering user provisioning, Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), and MFA enforcement.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 compliance activities, supporting internal security audits and policy documentation.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Designed and deployed a comprehensive SIEM detection rule library across Microsoft Sentinel and CrowdStrike Falcon NG-SIEM at UAL, mapped to MITRE ATT&CK, achieving measurably improved detection coverage across the full attack lifecycle.
- Built a SOAR playbook suite automating alert triage and enrichment, reducing mean time to respond (MTTR) and freeing analyst capacity for higher-value threat hunting activities.
- Validated detection coverage gaps using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), directly improving SIEM and XDR rule quality and reducing blind spots across endpoint, identity, and network telemetry.
- Delivered cloud security health checks across Microsoft Azure, producing actionable remediation roadmaps for identity, network, and data security controls.
- Successfully deployed CrowdStrike Falcon EDR across an 8,000-user estate, enabling full endpoint visibility and proactive threat hunting capability for the security operations team.

EDUCATION

- M.Sc. Environmental and Resource Engineering
- B.Sc. Chemical Engineering

CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
- CompTIA Security+
- Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
- CompTIA A+
- Google IT Support Professional Certificate

References available on request | Hybrid / Remote (UK)